

Memory Island — Student Guide

Welcome to Memory Island!

Memory Island is a next-generation learning platform built around **spaced repetition** — a scientifically backed study method that shows you flashcards at the exact moment your brain is about to forget them.

Instead of grinding through the same deck over and over in a single night, Memory Island spreads your reviews out over days and weeks. As your confidence grows, the intervals get longer. The payoff? You study less total time and remember more, because you're focusing your effort on cards that actually need attention.

Whether you're a nursing student grinding NCLEX questions, a pre-med working through pharmacology, or anyone trying to retain a massive body of facts, you are in the right place. Let's set sail.

Core Concepts

1. Cards

A **Card** is the fundamental unit of learning. Every card represents one piece of knowledge you want to retain.

Every card in Memory Island has a **status** that reflects how well you know it:

-  **Learning:** You've seen this card and are building familiarity with it. Brand new cards start here.
-  **Struggling:** You got this card wrong after previously knowing it — it needs extra attention.
-  **Mastered:** You've answered this card correctly enough times that the app trusts it is secured in your long-term memory (a review interval of 14+ days).

2. Islands

An **Island** is a collection of cards (essentially a "deck"). You might have an Island for *Cardiac Medications*, another for *Anatomy of the Hand*, etc. Think of each Island as one specific subject area.

Visual Mastery: Your Islands are alive.

-  **Stormy/Rocky:** If you have cards due for review, or cards you are struggling with, the island will look dark and stormy.
-  **Lush/Green:** When you clear your due cards and master the material, the storm clears and your island becomes vibrant and lush. Your daily goal is to clear the storms!

(Above: Notice how the visual state instantly tells you which subjects need your attention today).

3. Archipelagos

An **Archipelago** is a named group of Islands. Think of it as a broader course or a subject umbrella.

- **Example Archipelago:** NCLEX Prep

- Island: *Cardiac Medications*
- Island: *Respiratory Drugs*
- Island: *Fluid & Electrolytes*

Archipelagos let you study all related Islands together or drill down into a single Island when you need to focus.

Building Your Knowledge Base

Creating Your First Island

1. From the Dashboard, tap the **+ Create New Island** button.
2. Give it a name that reflects what you're studying.
3. Optionally assign it to an existing Archipelago, or create a new one.

Creating Cards (Creator Mode)

Inside an Island, click "Manage Cards" to open the 3-Pane Creator Workspace. Choose a card type on the right and fill in the content in the center canvas.

(Above: The Creator Mode allows you to build cards exactly as they will look when you study them).

 **Pro-Tip for writing good cards:** Stick to *one concept per card*. "What is the mechanism of action of metoprolol?" is much better than "Tell me everything about metoprolol." Be precise!

Memory Island supports six dynamic card types:

1. **Flashcard:** A front (question) and a back (answer). Best for definitions.
2. **Multiple Choice (MCQ):** Standard 4-option questions. Best for standardized test prep.
3. **Fill-in-the-Blank:** Type the missing word. Best for spelling and strict recall.
4. **Matching:** Drag to pair concepts.
5. **Multi-Select:** Select all correct answers.
6. **Sequencing:** Arrange scrambled items into the correct order.

Scenario Groups

For NCLEX and MCAT-style studying, you can use **Scenario Groups**. This pins a patient vignette to the top of the screen while a series of related questions cycle through below it.

How Spaced Repetition Works

Spaced repetition is based on a simple idea: **the right time to review something is just before you forget it**. Memory Island uses an advanced algorithm to track each card's **review interval** (the number of days until the card is due again).

- First correct answer → Due again in **1 day**.
- Second correct answer → Due in **6 days**.

- Third correct answer → Interval multiplies exponentially based on how easy the card was.
- Wrong answer → Interval resets to **1 day**.

What "Due" means: A card is "due" when its next review date has arrived. The app won't show you a mastered card every session — only when it's actually time to refresh your memory.

Study Modes

When you open an Island or Archipelago, you can launch a session using different modes:

Mode	What it does
All	Every card in the Island, completely shuffled.
Learning	Focuses only on cards you haven't mastered yet.
Struggling	High-priority review of cards you've been getting wrong.
Mastered	A confidence check on material you already know well.
Due (Default)	The most efficient way to study. Shows exactly what the algorithm says you need to review today.

The Grace Window

Want to study now, but your cards aren't due until tonight? Go to **Settings > Grace Window**. If you set it to `480 minutes` (8 hours), any card due within the next 8 hours will be pulled into your current study session.

Advanced Features

Offline Study Mode

Studying on the subway or in a hospital basement with zero cell reception? We've got you covered.

- **How it works:** Memory Island automatically caches your active Islands to your device. If you lose internet connection, you can still launch study sessions and review your cards without interruption.
- **Seamless Syncing:** While offline, the app safely stores all your study progress, grading, and streak data locally. The moment your device reconnects to Wi-Fi or cellular data, Memory Island automatically syncs everything back to the cloud. You never lose a drop of progress.

Tiered Card Progressions

Some Islands utilize **Tiered Cards** (created by the deck author). This is where mastering an easy version of a card automatically unlocks a harder version of the same concept.

- **How it works:** The progression is invisible and automatic. When you answer a lower-tier card correctly enough times to reach **Mastered** status (a 14+ day interval), the app automatically swaps it out for the next tier.

- **The Experience:** You might start with a Multiple Choice question about a drug. Two weeks later, once you've mastered it, that card will naturally evolve into a Fill-in-the-Blank question in your study queue.
- **The UI:** During your study session, you will see a subtle Tier 1 / 3 indicator on the card, so you always know where you are in the learning chain.

Defeating the "Illusion of Competence" (Written Recall)

Ever flip a flashcard and think, "Oh yeah, I knew that," even though you couldn't recall it 3 seconds earlier? To defeat this, turn on **Written Recall Mode** in your settings. This forces you to physically type your answer into a scratchpad before the card will let you flip it, ensuring true active recall.

Community & Collaboration

Sharing vs. Collaborating

- **Sharing (Publishing):** This creates a copy of your Island in the global **Discover** tab. When someone downloads it, they get their own independent copy.
- **Collaborating (Live Workspace):** Multiple people can add, edit, and delete cards in real-time. This is perfect for study groups dividing up the work. *(Note: Even in collaborative islands, your study progress and 'due' cards remain 100% private to you).*

SOS Flares & Community Support

Stuck on a card you keep getting wrong? When you fail a card, tap the **Fire an SOS Flare** button.

This sends the card to the community feed. Other users can throw you a **"Life Preserver"** by writing custom mnemonics, hints, or better explanations for you. If someone's hint helps you finally master the card, click **"This Saved Me!"** to reward them with rescue points!

Achievements & Leaderboards

Track your habits, earn badges for consistency, and compete on the Global Leaderboard. You can view all your unlocked badges in the **Captain's Quarters**.

Quick Tips for Survival

1. **Study Due cards every day.** 15 minutes a day beats a 3-hour cram session. The algorithm only works if you show up.
2. **Don't skip cards you know.** Marking an easy card "Correct" is what pushes it into the future.
3. **Use "Struggling" mode before exams.** Focused sessions on your weakest links offer the highest return on your time.
4. **Be honest.** If you sort-of remembered it, mark it wrong. The cost of seeing a card one extra time is low; the cost of a gap in your knowledge is high.

Coming Soon: Upcoming Features

We are constantly expanding Memory Island. Here is a sneak peek at what is on the horizon:

- **Evolutionary Islands:** Your islands won't just turn green; they will grow. As you build higher mastery streaks, your islands will level up, spawning docks, huts, lighthouses, and thriving port towns to reflect your long-term dedication.
- **Sunken Relics:** A new variable reward system! As you clear storms from your islands, you will have a rare chance to unearth collectible Sunken Relics (like Pirate Coins and Compasses) to display in your Captain's Quarters.
- **Advanced Content Tagging:** The ability to add micro-tags to individual cards so you can build dynamic, custom study sessions across multiple Archipelagos.